

Energy waves

A form of energy called “electromagnetic radiation” travels in waves, like waves on the surface of a pond. Just as waves in a pond can be close together or far apart, different types of electromagnetic radiation have different wavelengths.

The spectrum

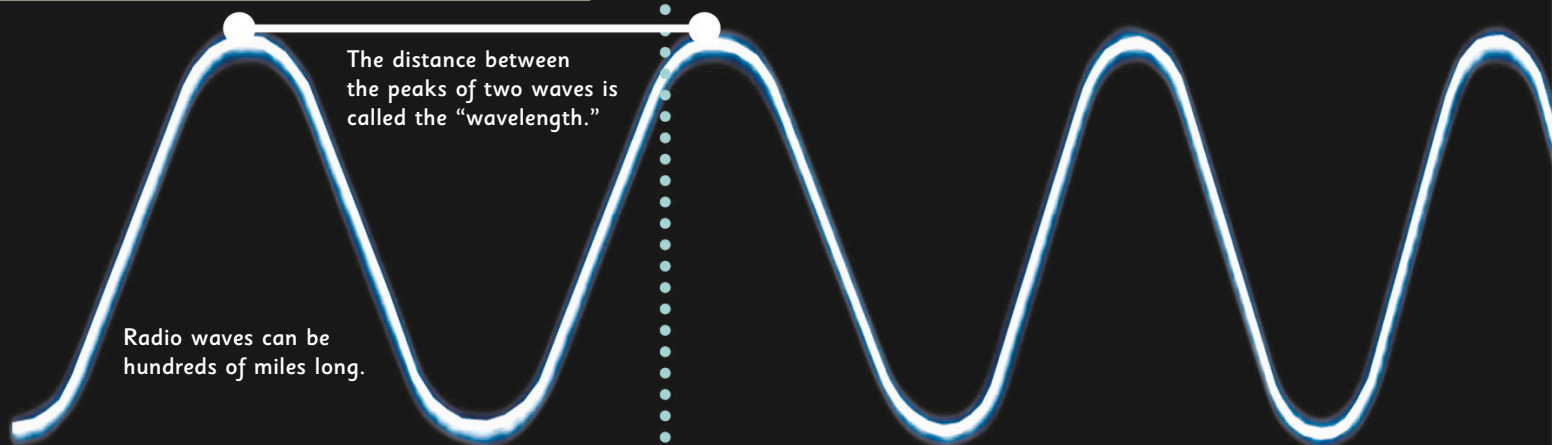
Visible light is a type of energy wave that we can see. There are other waves that are not visible to us, such as radio waves. The spectrum is made up of different types of waves, with varying wavelengths.



Radio waves ●

Radio waves have the longest wavelengths and are good at traveling far. Radio and TV programs are broadcast as radio waves.

Low energy



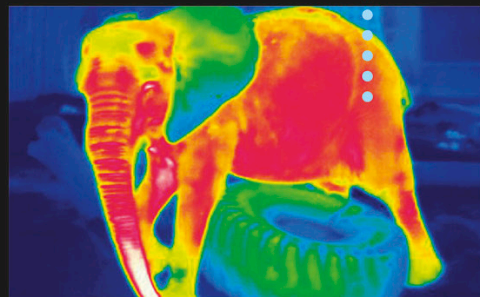
Radio waves

Microwaves

Infrared waves

● Microwaves

Microwaves are used to heat food in microwave ovens. They are also used by mobile phones and by satellites in space.



● Infrared waves

Hot objects give off invisible rays of heat called infrared waves. An infrared camera can detect these waves to create images.